

Store Passing and Boxes

CS 350

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Overview

Curly-Box: A Language with Mutation

Interpreting Boxes

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- Objectives

Store Passing Interpreters

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Curly-Box: A Language with Mutation

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- The value of the second expression is the value of the whole seq expression

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- We produce the value from wherever x points
 - 10, since we updated its value

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 - do `set-box!` on it
 - After function, new value will be seen

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- By using a purely functional approach, we define a semantics for Curly, even if it has mutation
- The semantics is informal, but still a useful tool for *understanding* stateful programs and languages

New Abstract Syntax

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```
(define-type Exp
  ...
  ;; Create a new box with the given value
  (boxE [e : Exp])
  ;; Write the given value to the given box
  (set-box!E [theBox : Exp]
             [valToWrite : Exp])
  (unboxE [theBox : Exp])
  (seqE [eFirst : Exp]
        [eSecond : Exp])
)
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 - We store locations as numbers, but that's an implementation detail

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 - Purely functional *implementation language*

Store Operations: lookup

- `lookup : (Location Store -> Value)`

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  (+ 1 (max-loc sto)))  
  
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- Used with override-store to extend a store to a new one with an additional location

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 - And take Store as argument

```
(define-type-alias Result
  (Value * Store))

(define (v*s [v : Value]
            [s : Store]) : Result
  (pair v s))

(define (interp [env : Env]
               [e : Exp]
               [sto : Store]) : Result ....)
```

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 - Design choice: which operand we eval first makes a difference

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- `define-type` and `type-case` are both Racket macros
- The entire Flit type system is implemented with Racket macros

A Macro for Interpreting with Stores

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```
(define-syntax with
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 - Macros extend the syntax of a language using the language itself
 - Macros are code that is run at compile-time

Why Bother With a Macro

- Makes code shorter

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- Makes intent clearer
 - “Interpret this code, then give a name to the value and store that result”

Using Our Macro

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(define (interp [env : Env]
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 - See in-class Racket if time permits

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Order Example

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{let1 {b {box 3}}  
      {+ {seq {set-box! b {* 3 {unbox b}}}  
          5}  
        {unbox b}}}
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- The first + argument is a seq expression

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- Final result 14

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```
(define-type Value
  (numV [num : Number])
  (boolV [bool : Boolean])
  (closureV [arg : Symbol]
            [body : Exp]
            [env : Env])
  (boxV [loc : Location]))
```

Interpreting Box

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(define (interp [env : Env]
                [e : Exp]
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  (type-case Exp e
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       (let ([loc (new-loc sto-v)])
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- Interpret the value we're putting in the box

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- Return the box with the new location
 - Return store is the store with the new location and value

Interpreting Unbox

```
[(unboxE a)
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    [else (error 'interp "not a box")])))]
```

- Interpret the expression to a value

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[(unboxE a)
 (with [(v sto-v) (interp env a sto)]
  (type-case Value v
    [(boxV l) (v*s (lookup l sto-v)
                    sto-v)]
    [else (error 'interp "not a box")])))]
```

- Interpret the expression to a value
 - Get the value and the store from this, since it might have had side effects
- Check if the value is a Box
 - Type error otherwise
- Get its location, and produce whatever value was at that location

Interpreting Unbox

```
[(unboxE a)
 (with [(v sto-v) (interp env a sto)]
  (type-case Value v
    [(boxV l) (v*s (lookup l sto-v)
                    sto-v)]
    [else (error 'interp "not a box")])))]
```

- Interpret the expression to a value
 - Get the value and the store from this, since it might have had side effects
- Check if the value is a Box
 - Type error otherwise
- Get its location, and produce whatever value was at that location
 - With the store from evaluating the box

Interpreting Set-box!

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```
[(set-box!E bx val)
 (with [(v-b sto-b) (interp env bx sto)]
  (with [(v-v sto-v) (interp env val sto-b)]
   (type-case Value v-b
    [(boxV loc)
     (v*s v-v
      (override-store loc v-v
                       sto-v))])
    [else (error 'interp "not a box")]))))]
```

- Interpret the box to a value

Interpreting Set-box!

```
[(set-box!E bx val)
 (with [(v-b sto-b) (interp env bx sto)]
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```

- Interpret the box to a value
 - Get the store from this execution

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```

- Interpret the box to a value
 - Get the store from this execution
- Interpret the expression to be stored to a value

Interpreting Set-box!

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[(set-box!E bx val)
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```

- Interpret the box to a value
 - Get the store from this execution
- Interpret the expression to be stored to a value
 - In the store we previously computed, getting a new store

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[(set-box!E bx val)
  (with [(v-b sto-b) (interp env bx sto)]
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        [(boxV loc)
         (v*s v-v
              (override-store loc v-v
                              sto-v))])
        [else (error 'interp "not a box")]))))]
```

- Interpret the box to a value
 - Get the store from this execution
- Interpret the expression to be stored to a value
 - In the store we previously computed, getting a new store
- Check that the box value is actually a box

Interpreting Set-box!

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[(set-box!E bx val)
  (with [(v-b sto-b) (interp env bx sto)]
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        [(boxV loc)
         (v*s v-v
              (override-store loc v-v
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```

- Interpret the box to a value
 - Get the store from this execution
- Interpret the expression to be stored to a value
 - In the store we previously computed, getting a new store
- Check that the box value is actually a box
- Return the other value, *in the new store with the box location overwritten*

Interpreting Set-box!

```
[(set-box!E bx val)
  (with [(v-b sto-b) (interp env bx sto)]
    (with [(v-v sto-v) (interp env val sto-b)]
      (type-case Value v-b
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          [(v*s v-v
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                              sto-v))]]
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- Interpret the expression to be stored to a value
 - In the store we previously computed, getting a new store
- Check that the box value is actually a box
- Return the other value, *in the new store with the box location overwritten*
 - Could have also returned dummy value 0, #t, etc.

Interpreting Set-box!

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  (with [(v-b sto-b) (interp env bx sto)]
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        [(boxV loc)
          [(boxV loc)
            (v*s v-v
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                            sto-v))]]
        [else (error 'interp "not a box")]])))]
```

- Interpret the box to a value
 - Get the store from this execution
- Interpret the expression to be stored to a value
 - In the store we previously computed, getting a new store
- Check that the box value is actually a box
- Return the other value, *in the new store with the box location overwritten*
 - Could have also returned dummy value $\emptyset$, $\#t$, etc.
 - Purpose is the side effect

Interpreting Seq

```
[(seqE l r)
 (with [(v-l sto-l) (interp env l sto)]
  (interp env r sto-l))]
```

- Evaluate the first expression *but do nothing with the value*

Interpreting Seq

```
[(seqE l r)
 (with [(v-l sto-l) (interp env l sto)]
  (interp env r sto-l))]
```

- Evaluate the first expression *but do nothing with the value*
 - Just get the store that's the result of evaluating it

Interpreting Seq

```
[(seqE l r)
 (with [(v-l sto-l) (interp env l sto)]
  (interp env r sto-l))]
```

- Evaluate the first expression *but do nothing with the value*
 - Just get the store that's the result of evaluating it
- Evaluate the second expression *in the store the first returned*

Stores vs Environment

- Environments enable *static scope*

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Stores vs Environment

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- Stores are inherently dynamic
 - We *want* them to always take the value from the point unbox is executed
 - Linearly threaded through the program
 - Once we've updated a store (by generating a new one), we *never use the old store again*
 - ... unless we implement more advanced features e.g. undo, backtracking